

Software Project Planning Guide

A practical guide for planning, building, testing, and launching a software project.

1. Project Goals

Define the product goal, target users, business problem, success metrics, and project scope.

2. Requirements & Features

List essential user workflows, authentication, core features, admin functions, notifications, validation, security, accessibility, and error handling.

3. Technology Planning

Choose the frontend, backend, database, APIs, integrations, deployment platform, and supporting tools based on project needs.

4. Development Phases

Discovery and requirements → UI/UX and architecture → frontend/backend development → database/API integration → testing and optimization → deployment → monitoring and maintenance.

5. Launch Checklist

Test important user flows, verify APIs and database persistence, check responsive layouts, optimize performance, protect environment variables, and verify production deployment.

6. Project Brief Template

Project name: _____

Business / organization: _____

Target users: _____

Main problem: _____

Primary goal: _____

Core features: _____

Preferred technology: _____

Expected launch date: _____

Budget / constraints: _____